in a phone interview that Chief Minister Shukla himself 'created' Deshpande's Jashpur job, which he started in 1951.[14] The administration gave him a budget for eight village schools, but after 'intense requests', he managed to get the resources for 108 and began to set them up.

In 1952, after the death of Thakkar Bappa, Deshpande decided that he wanted to work full-time on tribal welfare and that he could not do this while still in government service. So he approached RSS Sarsanghchalak Guru Golwalkar for help with setting up a social organisation. Golwalkar sent in the Sangh's Madhya Bharat prant head, Haribhau Ketkar, to help. Meanwhile, Deshpande approached the ruler of Jashpur, Vijay Bhushan Singh Deo, for assistance. Judeo provided rooms free of cost for a school, held a Vedic sacrifice with his nobles in his old palace on 26 December 1952, and announced a plan to build the new organisation's first tribal hostel, which would house thirteen children. Singh Deo's royal patronage was so intrinsic that the organisation remained unnamed for a year until he invited Deshpande and Ketkar for a conference at his palace along with several city notables in 1953. There, the royal priest of Jashpur suggested a new name: Kalyan Ashram. To meet the tribal students' expenses, Judeo decided to donate one-tenth of his personal yearly income to the project.[15] Shortly after Guru Golwalkar inaugurated ABVKA's first permanent premises in 1963, Judeo joined the Jan Sangh.[16] When princely privy purses were abolished by Indira Gandhi in 1971, he donated about 150 acres of land in the villages of Bageecha and Kardana to the ABVKA.[17]

From its inception, the Ashram defined itself as a Hindu counter to Christian missionary work in Jashpur. Its official history listed the large Christian presence in Jashpur in the 1950s as among the organisation's biggest challenges. The ABVKA claimed that, at the time, Jashpur had '10-12 big centres of the Christian Mission', 'about 200 nuns and priests' and '40-50 foreigners'. It said the missionaries had access to 'tonnes of porridge, oil, milk' to distribute, '8-10 big hostels' and 'one big hospital'. Presenting itself as a 'Hindu' social service challenger in Jashpur, the Kalyan Ashram school, in contrast, had '12 [students] and the hostel had 13 boys'. It was administered at the time by 'two people' and part-funded by a 'portion of what